

12-14 APRIL 1861

The first battle of the Civil War, fought at Fort Sumter, South Carolina, is a victory for the Confederates.



Union flag

11-16 FEBRUARY 1862

Ulysses S Grant leads a Union victory at the Battle of Fort Donelson, Tennessee.



Ulysses S Grant

4 JULY 1863

After a six-week siege, the Union army captures the city of Vicksburg, cutting off Arkansas, Louisiana, and Texas from the rest of the Confederacy.

15 NOVEMBER-21 DECEMBER 1864

Union General Sherman sweeps through Georgia, ending victoriously at the port of Savannah.

1 FEBRUARY 1865

Lincoln signs the 13th Amendment, which formally abolishes slavery in the USA.

9 APRIL 1865

Confederate General Lee surrenders to Union General Grant. The Civil War is over.

21 JULY 1861

The Union army is defeated at the first major battle of the war – the First Battle of Bull Run in Virginia. Almost 850 soldiers lose their lives (460 Union soldiers and 387 Confederates).

8-9 MARCH 1862

The Battle of Hampton Roads, off the coast of Virginia, sees the first combat between ironclad warships.

17 SEPTEMBER 1862

The Battle of Antietam takes place in Union territory near Sharpsburg, Maryland. With a total of 22,717 dead, wounded, or missing, it is the bloodiest single-day battle in US military history.

1-3 JULY 1863

The Union side halts the Confederates' advance at the Battle of Gettysburg, Pennsylvania.

8 NOVEMBER 1864

Lincoln is re-elected US president for a second term of office.



Lincoln Memorial

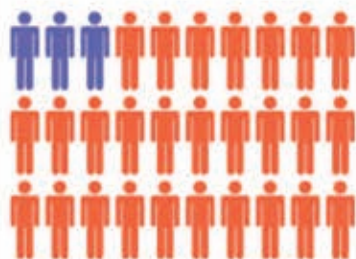
14 APRIL 1865

Lincoln is shot while at the theatre by John Wilkes Booth. He dies a day later.

1865

AFRICAN AMERICAN SOLDIERS

Roughly a tenth of the Union army was made up of African American soldiers (179,000). There are no records of how many slaves were forced to fight for the South.



SOLDIERS IN THE UNION ARMY

KEY

African American soldiers

White soldiers

UNION FIGURES

The people on this side were loyal to the United States of America. They were nicknamed "Yanks" or "Yankees".

ABRAHAM LINCOLN (1809-65)

As US president, Lincoln led his country through the war, abolished slavery, and saved the Union.

ULYSSES S GRANT (1822-85)

General Grant led the Union army from 1862 onwards. After the war, he served two terms as president.

JOSHUA CHAMBERLAIN (1828-1914)

Chamberlain heroically led a crucial bayonet charge at Gettysburg.

ROBERT SMALLS (1839-1915)

A southern slave, Smalls freed himself, took over a Confederate ship, then fought on the side of the Union.



UNION GENERAL

CONFEDERATE FIGURES

People from the rebel states in the South broke away from the Union and formed a new country, the Confederacy.

JEFFERSON DAVIS (1808-89)

A soldier and senator, Davis was the president of the Confederate States of America.

ROBERT E LEE (1807-70)

Virginia-born Lee became the supreme commander of all the Confederate forces.

JOHN BROWN GORDON (1832-1904)

This fearless Confederate general was wounded so often that people said he must be invincible.

BELLE BOYD (1844-1900)

A notorious spy, Maria "Belle" Boyd gathered information from Union soldiers.



CONFEDERATE GENERAL

LIVES LOST

In total, an estimated 620,000 men lost their lives in the Civil War. Where possible, Union soldiers received a proper military funeral, but the military cemetery in Washington DC soon filled. Arlington, Virginia, the family estate of Confederate General Robert E Lee's wife, Mary, was taken over for the new state cemetery.



ARLINGTON CEMETERY

COMMUNICATION

Both Union and Confederate leaders made use of the newly invented electric telegraph. They could send messages to generals on the battlefield and receive updates on the fighting.



TIN OF COFFEE ESSENCE



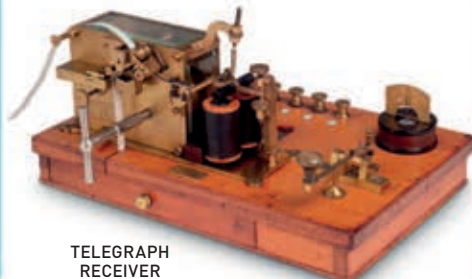
BLOCK OF TEA



ROPE



SLEEPING CAP



TELEGRAPH RECEIVER

MEDICAL ADVANCES

Although basic hygiene was still poor, great strides were made in treating the wounded. Horse-drawn ambulances transported casualties between field hospitals. Women worked as nurses on the battlefield for the first time.



SET OF AMPUTATION KNIVES



BONE SAW



BOX OF INSTRUMENTS



LIGATURE NEEDLES



SAW



CRIMPER



FORCEPS



SPRINGFIELD 1861 RIFLE



CONFEDERATE COPY OF THE SPRINGFIELD 1861 RIFLE



SPENCER CARBINE (REPEATING RIFLE)

THE SPENCER CARBINE
COULD FIRE SEVEN SHOTS
IN 30 SECONDS



CONFEDERATE DRUM

Those too young to carry a rifle enlisted as drummer boys. During battle, their drum calls communicated commands to the men.